

CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

AI Employees + Built-In Cybersecurity Platform for SMEs

Derived from prior Startup Validation Report | Target: India SMEs (10-250 employees)

Executive Summary

The venture aims to replace 4-6 disconnected SME tools (chat/voice AI, scheduling, helpdesk, basic security) with one AI-employee + cybersecurity subscription. The problem is real and well-documented; the bundling hypothesis is not yet customer-validated. This blueprint translates that into a buildable MVP: one AI employee, one vertical, security framed as a trust layer rather than a separate hard sell.

Ideal Customer Profile

Attribute	Profile
Company size	10-50 employees (core), 51-250 (expansion)
Vertical (Phase 1)	Clinics or law firms — high inquiry volume + real confidentiality stakes
Geography	Tier-1/2 India cities: Ahmedabad, Pune, Bangalore, Delhi-NCR, Mumbai
Current tooling	WhatsApp Business, Excel, manual booking; no dedicated IT
Buying authority	Owner or Ops Manager — single decision-maker, short sales cycle

Buyer Persona — "Practical Priya"

Attribute	Detail
Role	Owner/Founder, 15-40 person clinic/firm/agency, age 32-50
Daily reality	Handles sales, ops, HR, and unofficial IT; constantly interrupted
Core fear	Losing customers to slow response; vague fear of being "hacked"
Convinced by	Live demo of a missed call handled + plain-language security dashboard
Repelled by	Long contracts, jargon-heavy pitches, multi-week onboarding

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

- Missed calls/inquiries after hours (High)
- Slow lead follow-up via manual WhatsApp replies (High)
- Repetitive scheduling back-and-forth (Medium)
- No dedicated customer support coverage (Medium)
- Unnoticed phishing/suspicious login attempts (High)
- Fear of data breach/fraud with no IT budget (Medium-High)
- Owner personally answering routine questions (Medium)
- Lost leads not followed up after hours or weekends (High)
- No visibility into which inquiries convert (Medium)
- Juggling multiple disconnected tools/logins (Medium)

Customer Journey

Stage	Experience	Must Deliver
Awareness	Hears from a peer or sees a live demo	Jargon-free explainer + real demo, not a feature list
Consideration	Compares vs. "doing nothing" or 1-2 point tools	Clear ROI: cost of AI employee vs. part-time hire
Purchase	Wants proof it works on their own scenario	Self-serve setup <15 min; vertical-specific template
Retention	Wants to feel it's "just working"	Weekly digest: leads handled, calls answered, threats blocked

Key Customer Objections

Objection	Concern	Response
"AI will sound robotic"	CX/brand risk	Live unscripted demo in their own vertical context
"We're too small/not techy"	Complexity fear	5-min no-code, WhatsApp-style setup
"Is my data actually safe?"	Core irony objection	Plain-language policy, visible security badge
"Can we cancel anytime?"	Lock-in fear	Month-to-month, no long contract in Year 1

Key Buying Triggers

- Lost a deal/customer due to unanswered call or message
- A phishing/fraud scare (own or a peer's)
- Growth outpacing owner's personal bandwidth
- Peer or association recommendation

MVP Recommendation

Build First

- ONE AI employee: AI Receptionist / appointment scheduler (highest universal pain, easiest to demo)
- ONE vertical: clinics or law firms
- A lightweight, visible "security monitoring" indicator (e.g., login-alert flag) — not full security infrastructure

Do NOT Build Yet

- Sales agent, full customer support agent, or deep security detection engine — defer to post-validation
- Multi-vertical templates or multi-country localization
- In-house security infrastructure — partner/white-label instead

Success Metrics (first 30-60 days)

- 5-10 pilot SMEs actively using the AI receptionist demo
- ≥70% of pilot calls/inquiries handled without a human handoff
- Qualitative confirmation from interviews that the security add-on adds perceived value

MoSCoW Prioritization

Priority	Items
Must Have	AI receptionist (voice/chat), appointment scheduling, single-vertical templates, basic login/security alert
Should Have	Weekly usage digest, simple analytics dashboard, WhatsApp integration
Could Have	AI sales agent, second vertical, multi-language support
Won't Have (v1)	In-house threat-detection engine, multi-country billing, full customer-support agent suite

Pricing Hypothesis

Positioned below the cost of a part-time hire, month-to-month, no long-term lock-in in Year 1:

Tier	Price (₹/mo, hypothesis)	Includes
Starter	₹2,999-4,999	1 AI employee, 1 vertical template, basic security alerts
Growth	₹7,999-9,999	2 AI employees, analytics dashboard, priority support
Scale (Phase 2)	Custom	Multi-vertical, deeper security monitoring, API access

Validate willingness-to-pay directly in interviews before locking these numbers.

Top 5 Risks

Risk	Description	Mitigation
Scope creep	Building all 5 agents + security at once	Ship 1 agent, 1 vertical only
Security liability	A breach/false trust is reputationally fatal	Partner/white-label security API
Category confusion	Buyers unsure why receptionist + security	Test messaging in interviews first
Founder-market fit gap	No demonstrated SME-ops/infosec background	Add an advisor with relevant domain experience
Sales cycle mismatch	Legal/healthcare need compliance assurance MVP lacks	Start with lower-compliance verticals if friction appears

30-Day MVP Plan

Week	Focus	Actions	Output
1	Discovery	10 interviews across target verticals; probe reaction to bundled pitch	Top 5 pain quotes
2	Narrowing	Finish interviews; lock 1 vertical + 1 AI employee	Wedge decision documented
3	Thin MVP	No-code/low-code AI receptionist demo + landing page/waitlist	Working demo + waitlist
4	Pilot	Recruit 5-10 SMEs for free/low-cost pilot; track usage	Committed pilots + baseline data

- ### Scores (0-100)



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